



COME HOME TO THE STREETS
(Left and below) artwork by Anikesa; (right and bottom) exhibits by artist Nabi



ART ▼

A LIVING SENSORIUM

TRI Art and Culture's *ADDA: The Third Space* transforms Kolkata street life into an immersive artistic experience



This winter, TRI Art & Culture presents *ADDA: The Third Space*, an exhibition curated by the St+art India Foundation that transforms the institution's historic Ballygunge property into a multi-sensory journey through Kolkata's lived experience.

For the curatorial team, the goal was not to recreate the street indoors but to translate its embodied habits into spatial form. "Kolkata's streets carry an unusual density of life—the textures of hand-painted type, the quiet labour of kitchens, the sound of chess games on pavements, the sensory burst of food and conversation." TRI's triangular architecture shaped this approach. "We treated it as a porous container rather than a neutral white cube, working with thresholds, stairwells and landings where street cultures thrive."

> "KOLKATA'S STREETS CARRY **AN UNUSUAL DENSITY OF LIFE** IN THE HAND-PAINTED TYPE, QUIET KITCHENS, CHESS GAMES ON PAVEMENTS"

Among the installations, KHATRA's façade turns language into civic architecture, Howareyoufeeling.studio transforms a bed into a landscape of communal proximity, and Anikesa Dhing uses the sweetness of childhood candy to evoke memory. In the stairwell, Nabi's embroidered light totem explores hybridity, transformation and the politics of visibility. ZERO, Deep Adhikary and Dr Ishita Dey create a hybrid toilette-kitchen-scratch room that merges graffiti and olfactory research into an exploration of labour, gender, caste and domestic space. On the terrace, Sethu(ram)an and Padmanabhan (beatnyk) reimagine a pawn-only chessboard, inviting listening as a civic act; an orientation of care and participation.

For the curators, multisensoriality was essential. "Belonging in a city is rarely visual. It is felt in the body, in how one recognises smells, remembers textures, or shares food." Each sense becomes an entry point into this third space, and this dispersal of sensory access "democratises experience; people encounter the exhibition with their bodies first and their intellect later."

The founder of TRI, Varun Thapar, sees the exhibition as aligned with the institution's purpose. "Our vision has always been to build an institution that cuts across genres and disciplines. *ADDA: The Third Space* extends this ambition." ■

—Nikhil Sardana

The exhibition is on till Jan. 4